ENGLISH B2 · EXERCISE WORKBOOK

Narrative tenses

Printable practice for Narrative tenses in English B2. No explanations or solutions interrupt the work pages.

THIS DOCUMENT

Exercise workbook

30 learning decisions arranged in six progressive stages. Write directly on the page and consult the separate answer key only after completing a stage.

RECOMMENDED USE

Keep the three-document system together

Use the complete guide to understand the concept, this workbook to practise, and the answer key to diagnose each decision.

WELEARN STUDY SEQUENCE

01	02	03	04
complete guide	exercise workbook	answer key	retrieval review

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: completed events that move the narrative forward?

OPTIONS The lights went out and the audience became silent. · People were leaving when the announcement began. · The alarm was ringing because someone had opened the rear door.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: an activity already in progress around a shorter event?

OPTIONS People were leaving when the announcement began. · The alarm was ringing because someone had opened the rear door. · The lights went out and the audience became silent.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: an event completed before the current past viewpoint?

OPTIONS The alarm was ringing because someone had opened the rear door. · The lights went out and the audience became silent. · People were leaving when the announcement began.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “The lights went out and the audience became silent.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS completed events that move the narrative forward · an activity already in progress around a shorter event · an event completed before the current past viewpoint

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “People were leaving when the announcement began.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS an activity already in progress around a shorter event · an event completed before the current past viewpoint · completed events that move the narrative forward

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “The alarm was ringing because someone had opened the rear door.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS an event completed before the current past viewpoint · completed events that move the narrative forward · an activity already in progress around a shorter event

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

"The lights went out and the audience became silent." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Event line / Background process / Earlier cause · Gap 2: completed events that move the narrative forward / an activity already in progress around a shorter event / an event completed before the current past viewpoint

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

"People were leaving when the announcement began." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Background process / Earlier cause / Event line · Gap 2: an activity already in progress around a shorter event / an event completed before the current past viewpoint / completed events that move the narrative forward

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

"The alarm was ringing because someone had opened the rear door." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Earlier cause / Event line / Background process · Gap 2: an event completed before the current past viewpoint / completed events that move the narrative forward / an activity already in progress around a shorter event

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses completed events that move the narrative forward: _____. Choose the model that expresses an activity already in progress around a shorter event: _____. Choose the model that expresses an event completed before the current past viewpoint: _____. Choose the model built with past simple: _____. Choose the model built with past continuous: _____. Choose the model built with past perfect: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

People were leaving when the announcement began. · The alarm was ringing because someone had opened the rear door. · The lights went out and the audience became silent.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

The lights _____ and the audience became silent. People _____ when the announcement began. The alarm was ringing because someone _____ the rear door. State the full structural pattern for Event line: _____. State the full structural pattern for Background process: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “The lights failed; then the audience reacted.” using the Event line pattern to express completed events that move the narrative forward.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “The leaving was in progress when the announcement started.” using the Background process pattern to express an activity already in progress around a shorter event.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “The door was opened first; that caused the alarm.” using the Earlier cause pattern to express an event completed before the current past viewpoint.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “The lights failed; then the audience reacted.” using the Event line pattern to express completed events that move the narrative forward.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Event line to express completed events that move the narrative forward, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Background process to express an activity already in progress around a shorter event, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Earlier cause to express an event completed before the current past viewpoint, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

07 · RETRIEVAL

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____